

SAMUEL ABOLO

Personal Profile

Lagos, Nigeria • ikabolo59@gmail.com • +234 706 379 6022 / +254 116 542 430 • github.com/tecnosam

A software engineer who builds systems that survive real production load, but whose curiosity runs well past the terminal. The thread connecting all of it: a fascination with how complex things hold together under pressure, whether that's a distributed system, a chessboard, a fast break, or a four-hour DJ set.

WHO I AM

As a child I wanted to be an astronaut and go to the moon. I traded the rocket for distributed systems, but the instinct stayed the same: aim at hard, far-off things and figure out the engineering to get there. I work best where correctness matters, failures are expensive, and the problem keeps moving. Outside the day job, I am a builder by reflex, fluent across the stack and most at home in Python, with a strong owner's mentality that shows up whether I am reviving an abandoned codebase or starting a company's backend from an empty repository.

THE OTHER CAREER (IF ENGINEERING HADN'T HAPPENED)

I would be a professional DJ, playing raves, festivals, and warehouses in the mold of **Black Coffee**. There is a real overlap with engineering: reading a room, sequencing tension and release, and keeping a long set coherent is its own kind of systems design. It stays a passion for now, but it is the alternate timeline I think about most.

GAMES & COMPETITION

- **Chess:** ~1200 Elo on Lichess. Ongoing project to push the rating; the strategic, calculative side scratches the same itch as system design.
- **Basketball:** Play Forward and Point Guard, with handles I am genuinely proud of. Comfortable running the offense or finishing inside.
- **Call of Duty:** Active in CODM and Warzone; previously played Fortnite. Competitive, mechanically demanding shooters.
- **Minecraft:** The builder's sandbox. Open-ended construction and systems for their own sake.

TRAVEL

I love to travel and explore new places. So far: **Nigeria, Kenya, Rwanda, and Uganda**, with a standing intent to keep widening the map. Much of my remote work has been with teams across the US, Puerto Rico, and East Africa, so I am used to operating across cultures and time zones.

SIDE PROJECTS & INITIATIVES

- **Adugbo** — A local-first neighborhood information platform for Nigerian cities, launching with Lekki Phase 1 in Lagos. Web-first (Next.js 14, Tailwind, NextAuth with Google/Apple OAuth) with Go microservices and a mobile version to follow. Built around geofencing, content seeding, verification, and community moderation.
- **Bookclinic** — Co-founded as Founding Engineer / CTO; a healthcare appointment and booking platform, architected from the ground up.
- **Remilo** — Founding Engineer on real-time transaction monitoring and fraud-detection infrastructure for African fintech.
- **Self-employed builds (2018–2022)** — Inventory systems, trading trackers, real-time scraping tools, and an AI-powered medical suggestion API, all shipped for real clients.
- **Technical writing** — Working toward publishing the Spark-to-Ray/Anyscale migration story, and active in public developer/engineering spaces on software architecture topics.

WHAT I'M WORKING TOWARD

I am pursuing graduate study (US MSCS, targeting Fall 2027) alongside senior backend, ML-platform, and AI-engineering roles. My deepest technical interests sit in production-facing ML and agentic systems, fraud and anomaly detection, distributed systems, and the infrastructure that lets teams ship models without slowing down. The long-term goal is to keep working at the edge where research-grade ideas meet systems that actually have to run.

HOW I WORK

- **Owner, not a ticket-taker.** I take responsibility end to end, from system design through deployment and production support.
- **Comfortable in the deep end.** Reviving abandoned codebases, replatforming critical pipelines, founding engineering from scratch.
- **Clear across audiences.** I communicate the same idea to a staff engineer and a non-technical stakeholder without losing either.
- **Remote-native.** Self-directed, async-friendly, and used to distributed teams.